

Igor Balos

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Eligible to work in EU - Hungarian citizenship - Serbian citizenship

Senior Software Engineer

Senior Software Engineer with experience building production systems in modern full-stack environments (Ruby on Rails, Javascript/TypeScript/React). Focused on developing reliable, user-facing features in complex business domains, including transactional email systems, fraud detection, and domain verification workflows. Strong background in automated testing and system reliability, bringing a testing-first mindset to backend development.

Comfortable working across languages and stacks, able to adapt to new technologies. Strong product mindset, with experience working closely with support and product teams to improve workflows and reduce operational overhead.

Skills summary

Backend: Ruby (Rails), Javascript/Typescript (Node.js/Express/Fastify), Java

Frontend: React, Typescript, HTML, CSS, TailwindCSS, Bootstrap

Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, Docker, CircleCI, JenkinsCI, Github Actions

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch

Messaging: RabbitMQ (message broker), Sidekiq (background job processing), event-driven systems

Testing: Rspec, Vitest, Jest, Playwright, Selenium, Cypress

Professional Experience

Ghost, *remote*

Senior Software Engineer - Contract

May, 2025 – February, 2026

- ❖ Reinforced architectural alignment through conventions, code reviews, and collaboration with engineering leadership, focusing on long-term maintainability
- ❖ Improved consistency and maintainability across a large-scale application by aligning architecture patterns and engineering practices
- ❖ Introduced AI-assisted development workflows, defining conventions, guardrails to ensure consistent and reliable usage across the codebase

Tech - Javascript - Typescript – ReactJS – Rest APIs – Docker – PostgreSQL - BullMQ

Active Campaign, *remote*

Senior Software Engineer

April, 2022 – February, 2025

- ❖ Owned and delivered features for [Postmark](#), a high-scale Rails-based transactional email platform
- ❖ Developed a real time background service for fraud detection, which flagged 80% of fraudulent accounts while maintaining legitimate user access
- ❖ Built customer-facing features, like DNS setup flows (SPF, DKIM, DMARC) for email and domain verification
- ❖ Improved account approval workflows, reducing support load by 20% when handling suspended accounts
- ❖ Integrated [Rewardful](#) to enable seamless affiliate program management and referral tracking
- ❖ Engineered a global suppression tool, thereby cutting down on manual intervention by customer support representatives by 30% and enabling faster resolution times for customer issues

- ❖ Engineered comprehensive dashboards displaying spam incidents and critical account events, empowering the customer support team to resolve complex issues 2x faster
- ❖ Revamped slow performing DB queries and API calls, decreasing average page load times by 10% to 30%
- ❖ Enhanced application stability by resolving asset loading issues during the deployments, through AWS CDN migration, leading to a 10% reduction in support tickets related to front-end
- ❖ Engaged in weekly sprints, bug-fix cycles, and on-call rotations for Postmark and DmarcDigests
- ❖ Mentored new team members with structured onboarding, weekly one-on-ones, code reviews

Tech - Ruby on Rails - Javascript - Typescript - ReactJS - MySQL - RabbitMQ - Terraform – AWS - Redis

ALAS Doo, remote – part time
Software Engineer

April, 2020 – May, 2022

- ❖ Designed and implemented RESTful API endpoints to support client-facing features
- ❖ Upgraded Rails versions, to improve maintainability, ensuring compatibility across dependencies
- ❖ Optimized DB queries through strategic indexing and query optimization, leading to faster response times
- ❖ Increased test coverage from 20% to 70%, enhancing code reliability and deployment confidence
- ❖ Maintained and updated gem dependencies, resolving bugs to ensure product stability and security

Technologies - Ruby on Rails - PostgreSQL - Sidekiq

Wildbit, remote
Senior Software Engineer – Automations

April, 2019 – April, 2022

- ❖ Constructed an email delivery time tracking system, service that played a critical role in demonstrating the efficiency of Postmark email delivery, leveraging AWS Lambda for event-driven processing
- ❖ Delivered real-time email health monitoring, improving reliability by 25% and customer satisfaction
- ❖ Refined overall testing efficiency, allowing the team to run over 150,000 tests each day
- ❖ Reduced infrastructure provisioning time from ~1 week to ~1 hour by introducing containerized environments and infrastructure as code (Terraform)

Technologies - Ruby - Javascript - Docker - AWS - Terraform - Jenkins - JMeter - Selenium - Playwright

Wildbit, remote
Staff Software Developer in Test

May, 2017 – April 2019

- ❖ Built and evolved large-scale automated test systems supporting Postmark's core delivery pipeline
- ❖ Directed QA engineers through onboarding, tailored code reviews and focused knowledge-sharing sessions
- ❖ Engineered a multi-location performance testing enabling comprehensive simulation scenarios, to address bottleneck impacting system responsiveness during peak usage time

Technologies - Ruby - Java – Javascript - Jenkins – Selenium – GIT – SVN – JMeter – Redline13 – Gatling

Languages and Education

Master's degree, Computer Science, [Faculty of Technical Sciences](#), Novi Sad

Native or bilingual proficiency - **English • Serbian • Hungarian**

Elementary proficiency – **German**